REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL (RFP) FOR SELECTION OF AN IT COMPANY FOR DESIGN, DEVELOPMENT, UPDATION AND MAINTENANCE OF A NEW WEBSITE FOR PRAVASI BHARATIYA DIVAS (PBD) CONVENTION AND ITS MAINTENANCE



GOVERNMENT OF INDIA
MINISTRY OF EXTERNAL AFFAIRS
(DIASPORA ENGAGEMENT DIVISION)

Request For Proposal (RFP) for Engaging Services of an IT Company for creation of a new web portal by consolidating the existing portals hosted by DE Division, Ministry of External Affairs. and its updation and maintenance for a period of 24 months.

Tender No. Q/DE/11014/05/2025(A)
Date:13.01.2026

Time line for the Request For Proposal

Sr. No.	Item	Date	Time
1.	Date of Announcement	13.01.2026	1200 hrs
2.	Starting Date of Submission of bids	14.01.2026	1200 hrs
3.	Date of Pre-Bid meeting for any clarifications / explanation	21.01.2026	1430 hrs
4	Last date of submission of bids	02.02.2026	1200 hrs
5	Date of opening of Technical Bid	03.02.2026	1200 hrs
6	Date of opening of Financial Bid and the declaration of results subject to further scrutiny of documents	17.02.2026	1200 hrs

Estimated Bid Value: Rs. 70,00,000 Bid validity – 01 Year

Note : (i) The above mentioned time-line are tentative. The Ministry reserves the right to modify the time lines on the grounds of administrative exigencies. If any changes made by the Ministry in the time-line, the same will be uploaded accordingly on GEM Portal.

(ii) If any contradiction or ambiguity is noticed in any clause of the Hindi and English version of this Term of

Reference, the English version of the Term of Reference will prevail.

1. Introduction

Pravasi Bharatiya Divas is one of the flagship events of the GoI which has been celebrated since 2003 biennially to mark the contribution of Overseas Indian Community in development of India, and to celebrate Indian diaspora's connection with its roots at the apex level. The19th Pravasi Bharatiya Divas (PBD) Convention 2027 is scheduled to be held in January, 2027. For the event there would be registration of various category of delegates, online payment through payment gateway, PBD plenary sessions, youth PBD and cultural events. Besides, Ministry has been organizing **Regional Pravasi Bharatiya Divas** (RPBD) to reach out to a vast majority of our diaspora, who for various reasons, are unable to attend the main biennial event in India and benefit from its deliberation. These has elicited enthusiastic support from the India diaspora and the local Governments and have been highly successful. So far, ten RPBD have been held in different parts of the world. These also include **PBD conferences,** which are held during the intervening year with participation from overseas diaspora experts, policy makers and stakeholders. For these events, there would be registration of various category of delegates, online payment through payment gateway, PBD plenary sessions, youth PBD and cultural events. ***Accordingly, proposal from agencies are invited for creation of a PBD Website and Mobile App to work as a single window solution for management of entire process and work flow involved in PBD Conventions and Regional PBD Conferences.***

2. Objective

The objective of this RFP is to invite proposals from NICSI empanelled agencies for Web Portal/ Web enabled Application/ Website Development (herein after referred to as NICSI empanelled agencies) for Designing, Development and Maintenance of Website and Mobile App for **Pravasi Bharatiya Divas Conventions**. The aforesaid agencies shall study the requirement and scope of work as per terms of reference in the following paragraphs.

3. SERVICE REQUIREMENTS

After completion of the bidding process and work order issuance to the selected Agency, the awarded Agency should be responsible for the development, maintenance, monitoring (24X7X365 days a year) of the consolidated website. The websites' availability is mandated to be at 99.99% uptime when the network is available and without any hardware issues reported. Coordination with stakeholder(s) and communication involved in the portal management are to be carried out by the selected Agency.

This RFP is for the selection of an Agency for design, development and maintenance of website and mobile app for **Pravasi Bharatiya Divas Conventions**.The website and mobile app must have a dynamic and responsive design, address security issues, manageability of content while maintaining necessary compliances including GIGW compliance. The Agency should be having proven expertise in System Study, Design, Development, Implementation and Maintenance of Website / Web Portal / Web enabled application using latest available technologies like PHP, Java, .Net, Open Source, CMS such as Drupal etc.

4. Scope of Work for the Web Portal and Mobile App

4.1 Scope of Work for Website

The company would work under instructions and overall supervision of the Head of Department (DE Division), Ministry of External Affairs, New Delhi. The selected agency shall do a detailed assessment of the current system,prepare an AS-IS report,understand the current infrastructure challenges and issues.

The department is looking for the following features/functionalities for the Web Portal but not limited to:

- Web Portal design should be as per International Standard look & feel with ease of use.
- Design, Development and maintenance of Web based applications and integration with technologies like Payment Gateway, e-Forms, Financial Reports, etc.

- Web Portal should be responsive and dynamic with a content management system (CMS), where assigned users will be able to manage content. The department will provide the content.
- The selected Agency shall be responsible for uploading, updating, and maintaining all content on the website and mobile application. The Diaspora Engagement Division will communicate approved content changes or additions to the Agency in writing or through official email, and the Agency shall implement such updates promptly. The Agency shall ensure version control and maintain an audit trail of all content changes carried out during the contract period.
- User & Role Management for managing the content and modules of the Web Portal and Mobile App.
- The Web Portal should be accessed seamlessly from different countries and continents of the world.
- The Web Portal must be developed using well-established technologies preferably an Open-Source environment without using any third-party tool or framework.
- Web Portal must be fully compliant with Guidelines for Indian Government Web Portals (GIGW), Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG 2.0) and other GOI guidelines version latest at the time of handing over of the Web Portal.
- Comprehensive Security Audit by a CERT-In, Government of India empanelled / Government-authorized third party agency and the Web Portal must pass the CERT-In criteria and Comprehensive Security Audit. The vendor will be responsible for patches and bug removal during the security audit.
- The user manual, technical manual and source code with proper documentation (Complete Knowledge Transfer) will be provided to the department.
- Compliance with SSL certification.
- The facility of authorization-based uploading of content must be provided i.e. there should be a provision to authorize users from various departments who do uploading, editing etc. for their respective departments/sections. The vendor must provide the templates for the creation/updation of the contents in the web pages about their departments.
- Third-party integration services
    - Email
    - SMS
    - Payment
    - MEA from the Ministry Web Portal

(Note: An API will be provided by the department)

Dynamic CMS Pages

- All Pages need to be developed and maintained by CMS.
- There should be a complete Audit Trail Module, Administrators should have access to one log in the back end or individual logs of each page where authorized users can view daily reports.
- Admin should be able to manage the menu of the Web Portal.
- Any new sections, pages and modules can be easily added/edited or deleted.

User Management

- Create Users - with different roles by Super administrator.
- Administrator can create and manage users, user groups, roles, and role permissions with different roles like (Uploader, Approver, Publisher)
- Admin will verify the registration process and details of the users and approve the account creation.
- The application will allow the users with admin privileges to manage Users.

Role Management

- CMS will provide a role-based user access mechanism.
- Allow the users to create and manage the roles assigned to them.
- The application will allow the users with admin privilege to manage the role management of all users.

Key Features

- Prepare Mock-ups and Prototypes
- Design a new Web Portal into CMS
- Migrate existing data and content to the new Web Portal.
- Compliance with GIGW Guidelines
- Visitors count
- Media Coverage
- Video gallery and Image Gallery.
- Development of new features with the latest functionality
- Ensure scalability of the Web Portal to handle users
- Development of Interactive Dashboard/ Google Analytics/ BI Tools

- Development of an API to access registered user information by the stakeholders as required.
- Research Videos

4.2 Requirement Analysis

The website will provide all necessary information to the guests, dignitaries and participants. The features of website will be incorporated under the following Menu Heads:

1. **About Pravasi Bhartiya Divas**
2. **What's NEW**
3. **Program**
   a. Schedule
   b. Location of venue
   c. Panels/sessions/speakers
   d. Exhibition,
   e. Events
   f. Cultural Programme
4. **Online registration module :** The registration module shall have provision wherein interested delegates can register themselves with verification of their e-mail id and uploading of scanned copy of documents. Every registered delegate shall be provided login id which shall be same as their e-mail id (verified at the time of registration). The concerned user shall have provision to reset their password and shall have link for forgot password. A secured mechanism should be applied for the registration process with minimum exposure of applicants' data. Proper authentication and validation process should be adopted during data capturing in various registration forms. The delegates should be able to use payment gateway for online payment of the registration fee decided for their category.

   The online registration of the PBD participants shall be on the payment basis as well as on the gratis (without payment) basis. The online payment facility shall be made for the payment of the registration fee. The registration categories covered for payment and gratis basis will be as such:

(a) Payment based registration categories: Non Resident Indian (NRI)/ Person of Indian Origin (PIO)/Indian Residents.

- Registration Advisory
- Instruction for filling the online Registration Form.
- Registration fee details for different categories.
- Payment Options.
- Registration cancellation policy.

(b) Gratis based registration Categories: PBSA Awardees/ Panelists/ KIP Participants/BKJ Quiz Participants/Media/ Exhibitors/ Government Delegates:

- Registration Advisory
- Instruction for filling the online Space Booking Form
- Payment options
- Registration cancellation policy

The registration module shall have a mechanism to distinguish the registrations made under different categories and also the mechanism to keep a check on the unauthorized registrations made under gratis category.

The registration module shall include a mechanism for verifying the authenticity of the passport uploaded by the applicant and confirming that the applicant is the rightful holder of the document. The system shall ensure that:

1. Only valid passport documents are accepted through an automated document-type validation process.

2. Identity verification is carried out by matching the applicant's provided information with the data extracted from the uploaded passport.

3. A photo-based verification step is implemented to confirm that the applicant's photograph matches the passport photograph, ensuring that the applicant is the genuine holder of the document.

4. All verification processes comply with applicable security, privacy, and data protection guidelines, and no biometric data is stored beyond what is required for verification.

5. The Division may approve the final verification workflow during the SRS/FRS stage.

5. Exhibition: The website shall have provision for the exhibitors to make online payment (through online payment gateways) for booking the exhibition space during PBD. There shall also be a mechanism for the registration for entry passes of such exhibitors.

6. Online Payment Facility by implementation of Payment Gateway: The payment for the registration and booking of exhibition space shall be collected through the online payment gateways from the aggregators, selected by the Ministry. The agency shall coordinate with the aggregator partner for integrating the services on website and for the smooth functioning. The agency shall collect the amount that need to be credited to the consolidated fund of India on timely basis as per the details given by the Ministry. The integration should be carried out in a manner that enables secure handling of credentials, allows future onboarding of additional payment gateways without extensive redevelopment, and does not expose sensitive information to the client side. The solution should support transaction logging, reconciliation, and compliance with applicable security and audit requirements.

7. Archives (for previous years PBDs and RPBDs)

8. Visa and Travel Advisories

9. Pravasi Bhartiya Samman

a. Background

b. List of Awardees

c. Profile of Awardees

d. Award ceremony

e. Guidelines/Advisory

f. Process of nomination/Selection

g. Archives

10. Media contents

a. Press release/briefings

b. National and International Media coverage on PBD

c. Speeches

d. Interviews

e. Photo Gallery

f. Video Gallery

11. Partner State

a. Venue for the PBD convention

b. Introduction to the state

c. Information about the State like Culture, History, art, Cuisine and Tourist Sites

d. Reasons to visit PBD

e. Showcasing of state outreach activities

f. Tourism Corner/ Planner/ State Payment Gateway

12. Accommodation

a. General Advisory for Hotel Booking

b. Link for accommodation booking

c. State Payment Gateway for accommodation

13. Regional PBD Conferences

a. Upcoming PBD Conferences
b. Previous PBD Conferences
c. Registration & Payment Gateways

14. Downloads

15. FAQs

16. Contact us

17. External Links

4.3 SCOPE OF WORK WITH RESPECT TO MOBILE APPLICATION

1. General Features:

I. The mobile app has to be developed, in synchronization with process flow and work flow along with syncing of data. Mobile App needs to be created with all the facilities of website and compatible with all platforms i.e. Android, iOS, windows etc.

II. The mobile app shall be based on open source software and which can be connected and browsed without any scalability issues. The content of the Mobile App shall be of two types – one for external consumption by users visiting the website and the other for internal use of the stakeholders who all would access it through their role-based login ids.

III. The number of fields through which data shall be fed into the mob App, would be in combination of drop down menus/radio buttons/text box, as the case would be. The list of these would be provided by the DE Division. There shall be a provision for validation through login id for final publication of the contents on Mobile App.

IV. The look and design of the Mobile App should be state of the Art. Changes should be made as and when DE Division requests for the same. The Mobile App shall have provision wherein registered user can submit their grievance through their respective login id.

2.Home Page:

The design of the home page shall be innovative and creative. It shall serve as the single stop gateway for all visitors with separate links for information about Pravasi Bharatiya Divas Convention; various events during the Convention; announcements regarding date/schedule/update for various programmes, parallel events to be conducted by Ministry of External Affairs, Photo Slider, Video, Message from PM, EAM and MOS; Links to important Indian websites, Online registration of delegates, Online payment of registration fees; Payment gateway of banks; Information about PBD Venue and

Programme, PBD Panel Session, Information related to PBS Awardees, PBD Exhibitions related information, database of Previous PBD, Regional PBD, Photo gallery, video gallery etc.

3. Registration Module

The Mobile App shall have provision wherein interested delegates can register themselves with verification of their e-mail id and uploading of scanned copy of documents. Every registered delegate shall be provided login id which shall be same as their e-mail id (verified at the time of registration). The concerned user shall have provision to rest their password and shall have link for forgot password. The delegates should be able to use payment gateway for online payment. The Mobile App shall have provision to upload required documents.

4. Security

Password control should be possible with the option of changing the password by the user. Entry point of user should be definable. System administrator should be able to allow /disallow any option to any given user. System administrator should be able to restore and take backup of the data. Restoring of data should be possible without disturbing the live data.

5. Expectations

The Mobile App should have a responsive design based on current trends and technologies. It should have well planned information architecture with a pleasant colour scheme. It should have logical roadmap and be clear, concise and grab the interest of the user. Every component of the mobile App should work quickly and correctly. The mobile App shall be finally evaluated on the basis of user-friendliness, functionality, appearance, layout, navigation, style, content, design, sequence etc. The mobile shall to have inbuilt safeguards for protection from hackers.

User experience and security should be the important feature of the work. Only authorized Content managers should be able to login and access the designated sections/sub sections of the portal based on their profile. All the content managers will access the application only after user authentication and authorizations.

4.4 DETAILED SCOPE OF WORKS

This section provides indicative scope of work for empanelled agencies and would vary depending upon actual requirements of user department.

4.4.1 Designing, Development, Implementation, Training and Maintenance of Customized Web Based application/portal solutions/ Web designing w.r.t. the PBD Website. Indicative activities include:

Analysis

a. Finalizing the detailed list of activities, scope and duration of each of the activity and detailed project plan

b. Detailed discussions with concerned stakeholders to understand the overall objectives of the assignment

c. Finalization of Project Objectives/Requirements

d. Submission of detailed Project Proposal / Plan Sign off on detailed project plan, activities, timelines etc. from concerned stakeholder

Designing

a. Detailed Requirement gathering and analysis includes CMS design. Apart from uploading the contents the CMS will also enable the user to assign specific timeline for the contents to be displayed on the website.

b. Study and analysis of existing /Similar website/mobile app and include best practices in draft design

c. Carry out a System Study to prepare the SRS and FRS

d. Detailed High level and Low level application designs

e. Information Integration and Consolidation

f. Client Sign-off for Requirement Analysis

g. Preparation of Content Structure/ Information Architecture for the website

h. Preparation of prototype (design interface) developed by vendor

i. Coordination and collection of required content from the concerned stakeholder

j. Approval on the content gathered by the client department

k. Design should comply on all parameters with guidelines issued by Government of India for websites/Mobile apps

l. Comply with website security guidelines issued by NIC and DIT, GoI.

m. Comply with DBIM (Digital Brand Identity Manual) as introduced by MeITY for having a unified and consistent visual identity with other GoI Digital platforms.

Developing of the Website

a. Coding / Temporary Demo server

b. Content Population and content management system

c. Provide front-end user interface that allows a user, even with limited expertise, to add, modify and remove content from a Web site

d. Application Development and Unit Testing, Integration Testing, System Testing and Functional Testing

e. Testing of developed website based upon

- Compliance to applicable guidelines
- Assess the user objective achievement etc.

f. Ensure that the website is Guidelines for Indian Government Websites (GIGW) Compliance certified by STQC

g. Completed website components for UAT

h. UAT Sign-off by user department

i. Modification based upon user feedback

j. Sign off on developed website by user department

Operation and Maintenance support

a. <u>On-site technical manpower shall be provided during the PBD Convention after the website goes live.</u> Further, the maintenance support shall be provided by the selected agency for a period of 2 years wef from the date of launch of the website and mobile app which may be extended for a further period of one year at a time with a maximum of two extensions.

b. Identify and execute training requirements for successful execution of project

c. All content on the website and mobile application shall be updated and maintained by the selected Agency during the contract period. The Diaspora Engagement Division will communicate approved content changes, additions, or deletions to the Agency in writing or through official email. The Agency shall incorporate such changes on the website/mobile app within the timelines mutually agreed upon with the Division. The Agency shall ensure that all updates are version-controlled and maintain an audit trail of changes implemented.

d. Creations of necessary documents and User Manual for training

e. Support in handover of website to user department

f. Support on Training/ Demo on need basis

g. Warranty Maintenance / Annual Maintenance of website

4.4.2 Designing interface/ mechanism for Mobile based application

4.4.3 Implementation of map based Location Assistance system

4.4.4 Designing, development and integration with secured payment gateway

i. Maintenance of existing Online payment gateway services with acceptance of credit and debit cards (Visa, Master and Maestro) and internet banking of all public/ private banks providing such facility with the existing portal and any new / additional portals as specified by user department from time to time

ii. Generation of receipts/acknowledgment

iii. Automated reconciliation and generate necessary reports etc.

4.4.5 Design and development of the Electronic form application in Secure & Usable format

Portal solution may include development of a complete application for electronic receipt of e-Forms, MIS reporting for various stakeholders as required by the departments,

Monitoring and managing the various applications involved, etc.), printing of submitted application forms by respective departments, Status Update of individual e-Form application by respective department, Status tracking by users, Query Service and payment handling.

4.4.6 Adherence to Web Application Audit/ Compliance and Approval / Security Features.

The agency must get the periodic application security audit of the website by Cert-In empanelled agency including the cost involved. Service provider should also share the "safe to host certificate" along with the report with this division of the Ministry.

4.4.7 Design and Development of Web application Devices having capability to connect directly to Service Provider's central system through laptops, handheld devices, mobile etc. used for financial inclusion at grassroots level. Application should -

i. Provide multichannel support (Biometric service points, Internet operated devices, Mobile, etc.).

ii. Have standard interface capabilities (standards like ISO, XML, web services).

iii. Multiple backend systems interfacing capabilities.

iv. Capability of integration with the National Portal

4.4.8 Indicative Deliverables

- High Level Design/ Architecture Document
- Performance Test Reports
- Security Test Reports
- UI Usability Report
- Deployment Script
- User Manual/SOP
- Technical Manual
- Data Backup/ Archival Process
- Requirement Traceability Matrix

- Source Code
- Infrastructure design document
- Development and implementation of the online web strategy with major upgrades in the design and content of the current website.
- New website hosted and maintained on the new server
- Editing and proof reading of the website contents
- Development of new content for the website (an indicative list mentioned above).
- Frequent updates on the website.
- Prompt and Proper Maintenance of website.

4.4.9 The cost of Development & Maintenance of Website of PBD shall also include the cost of on-site technical manpower during the PBD Convention. All costs pertaining to the security audit, security certification and other related costs shall be indicated in the financial proposal. The DE Division will monitor the operation and maintenance of the website. The selected agency shall deploy qualified personnel on an off-site basis for the entire duration of the contract to support operational activities of the web portal and mobile application, including verification of user registrations, **content update activities** through CMS on the website as instructed by the Division, data validation, quality checks, backend maintenance, security patch updates and other operational tasks that may arise during the contract period. Agency must specify and share contact details of Single point of Contact for maintenance as part of the escalation matrix.

Other Features of CMS

- Open source technology/platform will be preferred.
- Domain and hosting will be provided to the agency from the department. The department will share access permission with the agency for deployment.
- The System Requirement Study (SRS) Document for the design and development of the Web Portal should be shared with the department for their review and approval.

- After the development of the Web Portal, the complete Web Portal UAT should be given to assigned officials of the department. After successful UAT, confirmation/certificate for the same would be given.
- After UAT sign-off, a security audit of the Web Portal should be processed before the go-live of the Web Portal.
- After the security audit Web Portal will deployed on a Production server with content migration and further made go-live with current domain mapping.
- One-time complete data migration from the existing Web Portal will be implemented, if desired by the DE Division. Further, the department will update new content on the Web Portal after CMS training. If required technical support may be asked from the agency for regular content updation activities on NICSI resource rate.
- The Web Portal **should not be down** during core working hours unless for an emergency like security breach. In such cases, the issue should be reported and resolved within an hour of occurrence. Regular maintenance should be scheduled during non-core hours.
- The Web Portal should be integrated with 3rd party services like email/SMS service etc. All required APIs will be provided by the department.
- Web Portal should be Mobile/Tablet Responsive, so it adapts and fits design as per user resolution.
- The Web Portal should comply with basic accessibility standards so that it caters to Disabled People (WCAG 2.0 Compliance).
- Web Portal should be Compatible with all the latest browsers (i.e. Firefox, Internet Explorer, Opera, Mozilla, Google Chrome, Safari etc.)
- A Security Audit should be done before going live by the CERT-In agency.
- The Web Portal will have a search & advanced search option.
- Web Portal content/pages can be shared on user's social media accounts.
- The following points should be covered as mentioned below:
    - The developer must ensure that, not violate any copyright law related to images, templates, code etc.
    - Any user input system must have a captcha system (Captcha must be neat and clean).
    - Web Portal must be optimized for Search Engines (Meta-tags, User-friendly SEO links Easy to Read Titles etc.)

    - No Installation of third-party scripts to track user activity ad scripts, and hidden backlinks to other irrelevant Web Portals.
    - There should be location access through the map on a contact web page.
    - A mechanism is in place to ensure that all outdated announcements are removed from the Web Portal or moved to the archive.
    - Web Portal has a Copyright Policy, Terms & Conditions and Privacy Policy, prominently displayed on the homepage. Feedback form to be provided on the Web Portal.
    - The Web Portal should provide a facility to upload the content i.e. Web Portal should integrate with the Content Management System.
- Identify and execute training requirements for the successful execution of the project along with preparation of the User Manual.
- Provision of an FAQ (Frequently Asked Questions) page to address common user queries.
- Warranty support of the Web Portal for **One year** (From the date of go-live) and 02 years of offline support (maintenance).
- Activities for warranty support of the Web Portal will be:
    - Rectification of bugs in the existing code.
    - Solution of issues reported in the running Web Portal
    - Any configuration in the existing code
    - There should be a point of contact at the agency during the warranty period.
- In case of any requirement from the department for additional modules/functionalities development in the Web Portal, which is not part of this scope, the agency has to analyze the work and share change request effort estimation with the department after approval of the change request can get the work done and submit their bills as per approved change request.

MANDATORY SECURITY FEATURES:

The following security aspects must be ensured by the selected agency in accorrdance with extant guidelines in this regard:

1. Annual Security Audit of the web application has to be carried out, or whenever a new module is added to the website through a CERT-In empanelled agency

2. Ensure that Portal is hosted in Data Centre located in India by Meity empanelled CSP with hardened server

3. All OS patches , applications must be hardened and latest stable versions should be upgarded

4. All server/ infrastructure should be configured with least privileges access at all layers. Server folders/ files should not be accessible without password and two- factor authentication.

5. Configure and save server logs for web application access logs, server logs, DB logs etc. for two years after contractual periodic

6. Incorporate security advisories released by NCIIPC, CERT-in, NIC for all layers of applications, database and server OS

7. Ensure proper backup of system, application and database in external storage device to be handed over to DE Division upon expiry of contract.

8. Personal data of applicants on the database should be kept in encrypted form. All sensitive personal data must be encrypted at rest and in transit.

9. Implement cyber security compliance and blocking of malware/ suspicious site/IP at server/ device level; and report the incident to the EG&IT Division of Ministry

10. A User Manual/ sop for the web portal to be developed.

11. Hosting and Deployment

Hosting of the Web Portal will be through any of the MeitY empanelled Cloud Service Providers (CSPs) as per existing policy. The department will provide cloud credentials to the agency; the agency has to deploy the solution on the provided cloud space. The agency has to give support to the Department for hosting and deployment of the Web Portal and application. After development, the agency has to get the security audit of source

code from a CERT-In empanelled agency. Security Audit and SSL have to be implemented on the portal domain/URL for 2 Years.

5. PRE-BID MEETING

A pre-bid meeting will be held on _____at ____hrs to clarify issues if any related to tender documents for all prospective bidders in Kartavya Bhawan 3, Kartavya Path, New Delhi. The Ministry reserves the right to modify the time lines on grounds of administrative exigencies which will be informed on CPP Portal. The interested bidders are requested to provide their name and adhaar card number at phone no. 011-24010918 and 011-24010783 and email id uspbd@mea.gov.in and so2oia2@mea.gov.in as intimation well in advance is necessary for generating entry passes for the building premises.

6. ELIGIBILITY CRITERIA & SELECTION PROCESS

6.1 Eligibility Criteria

DE Division of Ministry of External Affairs will evaluate the responses based on multiple criteria and will select the best overall solution to fit its needs. All responses will be evaluated in the following areas:

- Completeness of solution
- Expertise and experience
- Demonstrated customer service quality and support
- Previous relevant experience
- Agency strength and stability
- Account management
- Reporting capabilities
- Financial considerations

The Agency should be able to provide a qualified web designing, building and maintenance team,for undertaking this assignment. The Agency team would work closely with the DE Division of MEA. A confirmation letter from the Agency for being able to provide the qualified team should be attached.

The minimum eligibility criteria provided below for ready reference:

1. **Certificate of Incorporation**: The Bidder shall be a firm/ company/proprietorship firm registered under Indian Companies Act, 1956/ the Partnership Act, 1932 or as amended from time to time. The Bidder should be having GST registration with valid PAN/TAN. Proof of the same must be submitted. The Bidder must have a registered office/ branch office in New Delhi, India. A self-certification mentioning the address of the office should be provided for bid evaluation.

In case of registered companies, the Bidder should produce Articles of Association, bye laws and certificates for registration issued by the Registrar of Companies.

2. **Minimum Work Experience:** The Bidder must be having at least 05 years of experience in the field of web designing, building and maintenance. In case of MSMEs/Startups/SHGs, the minimum years of experience may be relaxed upto 03 years.

3. **Turnover:** The Bidder's turnover should be more than Rs.50,00,000/- (Rupees Fifty Lakh Only) average over the five years among FYs viz, 2018- 19, 2019-20, 2020-21, 2021-22, 2022-23 and 2023-24. A certificate to this effect from Charted Accountant must be submitted. In case of MSMEs/Startups/SHGs, the quantum of Turnover per annum will be relaxed to the extent of Rs.35,00,000/-.

4. **Financial Stability:** Bidder should have a positive net worth for any of 5 years among these FYs 2018-19, 2019-20, 2020-21, 2021-22 and 2022-23, 2023-24.

5. **Blacklisting:** An undertaking (self-certificate) that the Agency hasn't been blacklisted by any Central Govt./State Govt./ PSU/ Govt. bodies or institution and there has been no litigation with any government department on account of ITservices.

6. **Qualified Manpower:** An undertaking(self-certificate)that the Agency has resources having domain knowledge in Web Development Governance applications. Agency need to have a

documentary proof of Guidelines for Indian Government Websites (GIGW) Compliance expertise.

7. **Work Record & Minimum workforce:** The Bidder should have completed at-least 5 orders for website development during the past five years i.e., 2018 – 2023, with valuation of each order not less than Rs. 5,00,000/-. The Bidder must be equipped with requisite manpower for a similar scope of work, with not less than 10 employees on its payroll. An undertaking in this regard will have to be provided by the Bidder on company letterhead duly signed by the Bidder/ authorised representative.

8. **Earnest Money Deposit:** Bidders are required to submit bid Security of Rs 2,10,000/- (Earnest Money Deposit) without which 'Financial Bid' will not be opened. The bid security shall be submitted in the form of Accounts Payee Demand Draft, Insurance Surety Bonds, Fixed Deposit Receipt, Banker's Cheque or Irrevocable Bank Guarantee (including e-bank guarantee) from any of the commercial banks or payment online in an acceptable form in favour of Pay and Accounts Officer (PAO), Ministry of External Affairs, JNB, New Delhi. The bid security is normally to remain valid for a period of 45 days beyond the final bid validity period. Bid security of the unsuccessful bidders would be returned within 30 days of finalization of Technical Evaluation Report. MSMEs/Startups/SHGs are exempted against submission of EMDs will be granted as per extant government guidelines. They will be required to submit a Bid Security Declaration as per format attached (Ref. Annexure-I)

Note: Relaxation/Exemption to MSMEs/Startups/SHGs regarding turnover and experience will be granted as per Ministry of Micro, Small & Medium Enterprises (MSMEs) Policy Circular No. 1(2)(1)2016-MA dated 10th March, 2016 and Ministry of Finance Office Memorandum of even number dated 25th July, 2016 subject to meeting of quality and technical specifications in accordance with the relevant provisions of General Financial Rules, 2005.

9. **Sub-contracting or Joint Venture:** Sub-contracting or subletting job in the name of the bidder will not be permitted. The agency which has the work order shall only be considered for this purpose and would execute the contract directly. Also, bids submitted by separately incorporated vendors by way of formation of a Joint Venture (JV) or Consortium will not be considered.

6.1.1. Competencies

a. Past experience in creating and maintaining very professionally and exceptionally creative websites.
b. Excellent I.T. skills and project management skills.
c. Strong editorial team with communications skills to write clearly and compellingly in English and Hindi.
d. Ability to juggle priorities and deadlines and perform well under pressure.
e. Ability to respond quickly to the maintenance requirement in the post commissioning phase.
f. Awareness on the latest smart technologies for website development.
g. Ability to regularly maintain, update the developed website.

6.1.2 Essential Knowledge and Experience

a. Excellent Information Technology skills, with previous experience of website maintenance, management, editing, and/or development.
b. Expertise with HTML and content-management systems and latest trends and technology in website content and social media.
c. Strong analytical and research skills, including the ability to analyze audiences, attitudes, communications products and messages and to translate them into the design and implementation of effective websites.
d. Knowledge of the mandate and work of a government department website would be desirable.

7. Proposal

Interested Agencies are invited to submit their proposals for the assignment, which must include the following, as detailed subsequently in this document:

(i) Technical Proposal and

(ii) Financial Proposal

7.1 Technical proposal

The Agencies are expected to provide the Technical Proposal as specified in the RFP Document. Material deficiencies in providing the information requested for may result in rejection of a proposal.

The Technical Proposal should contain the following documents:

Sl. No.	Description	Document/Proof
1	Details of Agency mentioning the name,address, Email and mobile phone number of the bidder/ authorized representative , Proof of GST registration and valid PAN/TAN.	Details are to be submitted in the format given in Tech Bid:Details of the Bidder Organization - Copy of GST Regn Certificate - Copy of PAN Card - Copy of TAN Card
2	The Agency should produce Articles of Association (in case of registered firms),Bye laws and certificates for registration issued by the Registrar of Companies.	Certificate of incorporation issued by the Registrar of companies along with Memorandum of Articles of Association (Please upload only relevant portions)
3	The Agency should hold a valid CMMI Level 5 certificate issued by CMMI Institute only. The certificate to be valid at least till go-live.	Copy of valid CMMI certification
4	Proof of Agency's turnover for any of the 5 years among Fys viz, 2018-19, 2019-20, 2020-21, 2021-22, 2022-23 and	A certificate to this effect from Charted Accountant in original must be submitted. And Copies of

	2023-24	Income Tax returns for any of the 5 years among FYs (2018-19, 2019-20, 2020-21, 2021-22, 2022-23 and 2023-24).
5	An undertaking (self-certificate) that the Agency hasn't been blacklisted by a central/state Government institution and there has been no litigation with any government department on account of IT services.	Declaration that the bidder has not been blacklisted
6	Certificate from any of the Government body that the Agency has resources having domain knowledge in Web Development Governance applications. Agency need to have a documentary proof of Guidelines for Indian Government Websites (GIGW) Compliance expertise.	Certificate from any of the Government body as a proof.
7	The bidder should have completed at-least 5 orders for website development during the past five years i.e., 2018 –23 with requisite manpower for a similar scope of work.	Copies of purchase orders in any of the 5 years among FYs 2018-19, 2019-20, 2020-21, 2021-22, 2022-23 and 2023-24 and linked satisfactory completion certificates may be submitted as supporting documents.
8	Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) for amount of Rs.2,10,000/- (Rupees Two Lakh and ten thousand Only) along with Technical Bid.	The EMD may be submitted in the form of Accounts Payee Demand Draft, Insurance Surety Bonds, Fixed Deposit Receipt, Banker's Cheque or Irrevocable Bank Guarantee (including e-bank guarantee) from any of the commercial banks or payment online in an

		acceptable form in favour of Pay and Accounts Officer (PAO), Ministry of External Affairs, Akbar Bhawan, New Delhi.
9	Presentation	Prospective bidders are required to submit proposed layout with suggested changes in respect of the websites in Para 2 of RFP (other than Global Indian Students Portal). The broad layout architecture of the website should be persistent with MEA's guidelines in this regard.
10	Organization Profile	As per Annexure-II
11	Other Details	(i) Undertaking for minimum staff strength (ii) Profile and Track Record of the Agency. (iii) Case studies of large brands handled, with focus on results achieved through web designing and development. (iv) Detail of award-winning web designing and building assignment (s) handled, if any. (v) Defined deliverables have to be mentioned in the technical proposal with timelines. (vi) Detail of the team proposed to be deployed to work with the MEA, with qualifications and experience of

		the team members must be provided
Note- The physical copy of the technical bid that have been uploaded online by the bidder may also kindly be submitted in person to the Division on 04.02.2026 at the address mentioned below- Sh. Kushal Kumar Singh, US(DE), Room no. 33118, Kartavya Bhawan-03, Kartavya Path, New Delhi.		

7.2 Financial Proposal

In preparing the Financial Proposal, Agencies are expected to take into account the requirements and conditions outlined in the RFP document.

The Financial Proposal should include:
(i) Total fee, from the date of issue of work order. For Financial Evaluation, the total fee for the assignment will be considered. This Fee should all include costs/expenses of the Agency for undertaking work as detailed in the Scope of Work.

(ii) Break-up of costs for each of the items of work listed in the Scope of Work are to be submitted as per BOQ format.

It is to be noted that
a) Taxes / CGST/SGST/IGST as applicable in India will be paid as per actual and the same are not required to be indicated in the financial bid.

b) The cost quoted will be firm and fixed for the duration of performance of the contract. At no point of time will any deviation from the quoted rate be entertained by Ministry.

c) The Financial Bid should not include any conditions attached to it and any such conditional financial proposal should be rejected summarily.

d) All prices should be quoted in Indian Rupees and indicated both in figures and words. Figures in words will prevail.

Criteria for Technical Evaluation

During technical evaluation, Bidders may be asked for an interview interaction with Technical Evaluation Committee. Minimum qualifying marks for technical evaluation will be 75 out of 100. Proposals will be evaluated as per following technical criteria :

S.No	Criteria	Max Marks	Cut-Off Marks	Documents for submission
	Past Experience in work of similar nature; Bidder with experience of above 10 years – **30 Marks** Bidder with experience of 8 to 10 years – **25 Marks** Bidder with experience of 5 to 7 years (3 to 7 years for MSMEs/ SHGs/Startup) – **22.5 Marks**	30	22.5	Copy of company registration certificate
3	Credentials of the Website maintenance team Experience of web designer(5) Experience of developer(10) Experience of system administrator(5)	20	15	CV of team members *Team members should be on the payrolls of the bidder * CV should be signed by Individuals
4	Agency credentials Bidder should have CMMI level 5 certificate issued by CMMI Institute	10	10	Valid certificate
5	**Number of projects* of value not less than Rs. 5 lakh each completed in last 3 years;**	30	22.5	Work order and Completion Certificate from Client

	i) For 1 to 3 projects* : **(22.5)** ii) For 4 to 6 projects* : **(25)** iii) For 7 or more projects*: **(30)**			
6	**Number of staff employed on the payroll of the company;** (i) For 10 to 15 employees: 7.5 (ii) For 16 to 20 employees: 9 (iii) For more than 20 employees: 10	10	7.5	Self- certified copy of no. of Organization Profile (Annexure-II; to be attached with Technical Bid)

A minimum score of 75 points would be required to qualify for the opening of Financial Bid.

A Proposal shall be rejected at this stage if it does not respond to important aspects of the RFP.

7.3 EVALUATION OF FINANCIAL BIDS.

FINANCIAL BIDS OF ONLY THOSE BIDDERS WHO MEET THE TECHNICAL CRITERIA WOULD BE OPENED.

The Financial Bids of the technically qualified bidders will be evaluated and the bidder who will quote the total lowest quote will be awarded the contract.

7.3.1 The contract shall be awarded on the basis of the lowest rate quote. L1 will be decided on the basis of sum total of all items in BOQ.

7.3.2 If a firm quotes NIL charges/consideration, the bid shall be treated as unresponsive and will not be considered.

7.3.3 If two or more bidders have offered the same rate, the bidder scoring higher marks at technical stage shall be awarded the contract. In case, there are more than one L1 with the same technical score, the work will be awarded to the bidder with higher turnover. If turnover is also same, decision of Evaluation Committee will be final based on other parameters, as determined by the Committee.

7.3.4 During the period, no request for increase in quoted rates shall be accepted under any circumstances.

8. CONTRACT PERIOD.

8.1 The successful bidder will enter into an agreement with Diaspora Engagement Division, Ministry of External Affairs. The period of contract will be **valid for 24 months** from the date of award of launch of web portal and the mobile app and this may be extended up to further 12 months on same rate for a maximum of two times, terms and conditions and on the basis of mutual written consent of both the parties.

8.2 The total Project time shall be 120 Business days. Project execution will begin within 15 days of approval of the project. The selected agency will define the project timelines, milestone in consultation. The selected agency is responsible to deliver the software as per time agreed.

8.2 In case services of the Agency is found unsatisfactory, the services of the Agency may be terminated immediately without any advance notice. MEA reserves the right of making appraisal of the services of the Agency.

8.3 The Ministry has the right to terminate the contract if during the review process, it is found by Ministry that the services rendered by Service Provider/Event Agency did not meet the standards of quality and efficiency of the services expected of the Agency as per the RFP.

8.4 **Compensation Clause:** MEA reserves the right to claim compensation to cover its losses for organizing the rest of the events at higher rate in case of non-performance or sub-par

rendering of services by Bidder leading to termination of contract. MEA may also recover the extra expenses that need to be borne by MEA in case a new Bidder has to be hired at a hired rate in case of non-performance of Bidder as per perfomance criteria. In addition to this, MEA would reserve the right to impose any other penalty including blacklisting of the Bidder.

8.5 BREAK UP OF THE COST FOR THE PROJECT

Sl. No.	Description	Charges (INR)*
(i)	Total fee, include all costs/expenses of the Agency for undertaking work as detailed in the Scope of Work. And two Onsite resource for support during the PBD Convention	
(ii)	Security Audit (Two times by CERT-IN Empanelled auditor)	
(iii)	GIGW Compliance (One time)	
(iv)	SSL for two years	
(v)	Off site AMC for two years	
	Total	

* Applicable taxes will be paid extra.

9. PERFORMANCE SECURITY.

Performance security is also required to be submitted by the successful bidder awarded with the contract irrespective of its registration status etc. Performance Security will be about 5% of the contract value. Performance security may be furnished in the form of Insurance Surety Bonds, Account Payee Demand Draft, Fixed Deposit Receipt from a commercial bank, Bank Guarantee (including e-bank guarantee) from any of the commercial or payment online in an acceptable form in favour of Pay and Accounts Officer (PAO), Ministry of External Affairs, JNB, New Delhi. Performance security should remain valid for a period of 60 days, beyond the date of completion of all contractual obligations of the successful bidder including warranty obligations.

10. MODE OF PAYMENT.

10.1 Payment against bill/Invoice shall be released only after execution of the order and the quality of the services are found to the satisfaction of MEA.

10.2 Initial payment to the bidder for the succesful development of the website (Ref. Para I of BOQ) will be made after successful commissioning, after Go-Live. Payment for maintenance will be made after expiry of warranty support on quarterly basis, after expiry of each quarter, on the basis of satisfactory certificate issued by competent authority.

10.3 Payment will be made direct to the supplier through NEFT/RTGS or through A/c payee cheque. No request for other mode of payment will be entertained. payment will be made to the Bidder on a pro rata basis, wherever applicable.

10.4 Payment will be made as per applicable deductions/ penalties as per RFP. ***No advance payment will be made in any case.***

11. PENALTY CLAUSE AND FORCE MAJEURE.

Refusal or inability or delay or any false statement by the bidder to supply all deliverables as per Scope of Work at the contracted rate may result in termination of the contract and forfeiting of Performance Security/revoking of Bank Guarantee as well as disqualification of the bidder from participating in future tenders of the Government. For any kind of delay in adhering to the time schedule or substandard work, the amount of penalty would be decided by the Ministry as follows:

Sl.No.	**Milestone / Deliverable**	**Expected date of Delivery**	**Penalty amount**
(i)	Start of Project Execution	15 Days from Award of	2% of Total Contract Value

		Contract	
(ii)	Completion of final outlay of website & Mobile Application Designs and Integration of modules Layout	75 Days	4% of Total Contract Value
(iii)	Submission of the Final Deliverables	120 Days	0.5% of contract value per week, subject to maximum of 5% of Total Contract Value

Ministry may consider relaxing the penalty and delivery requirements, if and to the extent the delay in performance or failure to perform its obligations under the contract is the result of a Force Majeure.

11.1 FORCE MAJEURE.

War, invasion, revolution, riots, lockouts, strikes, work shut down imposed by Government Acts or legislature or other authorities, Acts of God, which has affect for more than 5 day and which shall directly or indirectly prevent completion of the project within time specified in the Agreement, shall be considered Force Majeure. The Bidder shall in writing inform the ministry about the inability to fulfil the terms of the agreement, due to a force majeure event. Bidder shall be granted necessary extension to cover the delay caused by Force Majeure without any financial repercussions or the Ministry may issue revised guidelines or instructions.

12. CORRUPT OR FRAUDULENT PRACTICES

12.1 It is expected that the bidders who wish to bid for this tender have highest standards of ethics.

12.2 Ministry shall reject bid if it determines that the bidder recommended for award has engaged in corrupt or fraudulent practices while competing for this contract.

12.3 Ministry may declare a bidder ineligible, either indefinitely or for a stated duration, if it at any time determines that the bidder has engaged in corrupt and fraudulent practices during the execution of contract.

13. SETTLEMENT OF DISPUTES AND ARBITRATION

If any dispute could not be settled between the parties through consultation then such dispute shall be referred to Arbitration where each parties shall appoint one Arbitrator who shall act as presiding Arbitrator, under the Arbitration and Conciliation Act 1996, as amended up to date. The Arbitration Tribunal shall be entitled to extend the time of Arbitration proceedings with the consent of Parties. The venue of such Arbitration shall be at New Delhi. The language of Arbitration proceeding shall be English. The Arbitration and administrative charges shall be borne equally by Parties.

14. GOVERNING LAWS

This shall be construed and governed by the Laws of the India and the parties hereby submit to the exclusive jurisdiction of the Delhi Courts of Law for any interim reliefs.

15. DISCLAIMER CLAUSE

The information provided in this tender document is for informational purposes only and does not constitute a legal offer. The Ministry of External Affairs reserves the right to modify, amend, or cancel this tender at any time without assigning any reason. The Ministry of External Affairs is not responsible for any errors, omissions, or inaccuracies in this document. Bidders are advised to conduct their own due diligence and verify all information before submitting a bid. The issuance of this tender document does not imply that the Ministry of External Affairs is obligated to award a contract. The Ministry of External Affairs reserves the right to reject any or all bids without assigning any reason. Bidders are solely responsible for understanding and complying with all

applicable laws, regulations, and requirements related to this tender.

17. GENERAL TERMS AND CONDITIONS

All terms and conditions of the engagement shall be as per the terms and conditions of the NICSI empanelment with addition to the following:

i. Any software,hardware,UI designs, data, awards, certificates, patent, etc. shall be the absolute property of DE Division of MEA.

ii. Any software licenses during the development and deployment shall be licensed in the name of DE Division of MEA and the cost will be borne by the selected vendor.

Iii. The selected Agency will hand-over all Intellectual Property Rights in the Software developed to DE Division of MEA.

iv. The selected Agency shall relinquish to the DE Division of MEA, the complete source code of the developed applications within Five(5) working days from the date of acceptance/Go-Live of the system.

v. The selected Agency shall follow a periodic release management plan for bug-fixes/patches/maintenance and upgrades in mutual agreement with DE Division of MEA. The complete source code for each individual release shall be handed over to MEA within Five (5) working days after UAT confirmation is received from DE Division of MEA on the new release.

vi. The source code supplied to the department shall always be a complete, accurate, and up-to-date copy corresponding exactly to the current production release of the software.

vii. Mere submission of bid, shall not confer any right whatsoever on the submitting entity.

viii. The RFP shall remain valid for a period of 6 months from the date of publication of RFP.

ix. It shall be obligatory on part of the submitting entity to furnish any further information as may be sought by Ministry.

x. Incomplete proposals are liable to be rejected.

xi. The Ministry, may in its discretion extend the last date for submission of the bids and such extension shall be binding on all the Bidders. Addendum/Corrigendum, if any in this regard, will be published on the Ministry of External Affairs' website and Central Public Procurement (CPP) Portal.

xiii. The Ministry reserves the rights to reject any bid without assigning any reasons. The decision of the Competent Authority in this regard shall be final and binding on the parties concerned.

xiv. Bids should only be submitted online through e-procurement model (CPPP).

Sd/-
(Ankan Banerjee)
Joint Secretary (DE)
E-mail: jsdeoia@mea.gov.in
Tel: 2415-6441

Annexure-I

BID SECURITY DECLARATION FORMAT

We, the undersigned, declare that:

We, M/s.....(herein referred as bidder) understand that, according to bid clause No.... Bids may be supported with a Bid Securing Declaration, therefore, rather than submitting the Earnest Money Deposit, bidder render the declaration that:-

Bidder will automatically be suspended from being eligible for bidding in any contract with the Ministry of External Affairs for a period of 3(Three) years, starting on bid submission closing date, if bidder are in breach of any of the following obligation(s) under the bid conditions:-

(a) If a Bidder withdraws the proposal or increases the quoted prices after opening of the proposal and during the period of bid validity period or extended period, if any.

(b) In case of successful Bidder, if the Bidder fails to sign the agreement in accordance with the terms and conditions(including timelines for execution of the agreement) of this tender or fails to furnish the Performance Bank Guarantee(if applicable) in accordance with the terms and conditions(including timeslines for furnishing PBG) of this tender.

(c) During the bid process, if a Bidder indulges in any act as would jeopardize or unnecessarily delay the process of bid evaluation and finalization.

Bidder understands that this declaration shall expire if Bidder is not the successful Bidder and on receipt of purchaser's notification of the award to another Bidder, or thirty days after the validity of the bid; whichever is earlier.

(Signature)
Authorised Signatory Name:
Designation

Office seal

Place

Date

Annexure-II

ORGANIZATION PROFILE

(To be submitted as a part of Technical Proposal)

Sl No.	Criteria	Particulars (to be filled in by bidder & self- attested)
1.	Name of the Company	
2.	Date/ Year of Incorporation	
3.	No. of employees in company's payroll	
4.	Nature of Services being Provided	
5.	Outstanding Achievements & Awards, if any	
6.	Attached/ Partner offices in India & abroad, if any	

7.	Client(s) in public sector/ PSUs, if any	
8.	Contact Details & Social Media Handle, if any	